TOGETHER, WE RISE

WITH EXCELLENCE. WITH PURPOSE.

# Metropolitan Learning Center Programmatic Restructuring

February 24, 2026

# Learning Target and Success Criteria

| |
|---|
| **I am learning** about the data that informed the decision to conclude the 9-12 programming at Metropolitan Learning Center. |
| **I can** articulate the reasoning and context surrounding the decision. |

# Our Investments in Alternative Learning

## Quality, Stability, Equity of Access

### Sustaining the **Quality** of the High School Experience

Over time, enrollment in our alternative learning environment has declined to a level where we are no longer able to consistently provide:

- A broad and responsive range of course options
- Stable staffing and the depth of instructional support students need
- The diverse pathways, wraparound services, and personalized supports that define strong alternative programs

When enrollment falls below a sustainable level, the flexibility, individualized attention, and comprehensive supports that students rely on become increasingly difficult to maintain.

### Staffing **Stability** and Instructional Continuity

A strong alternative learning environment depends on:

- Educators who can provide personalized, relationship-centered instruction
- Flexible yet reliable schedules that support individualized pathways
- Consistent staffing that builds trust and continuity for students

When enrollment drops to very small levels, staffing often requires split roles, blended groupings, and complex scheduling structures. Over time, these adjustments can strain the individualized supports and stability that alternative learning environments are designed to provide.

### **Equity of Access** to Opportunity

Students in alternative learning environments deserve meaningful academic opportunities, enrichment, and strong peer connections.

At the current scale, it is difficult to provide the same range of experiences available in larger settings.

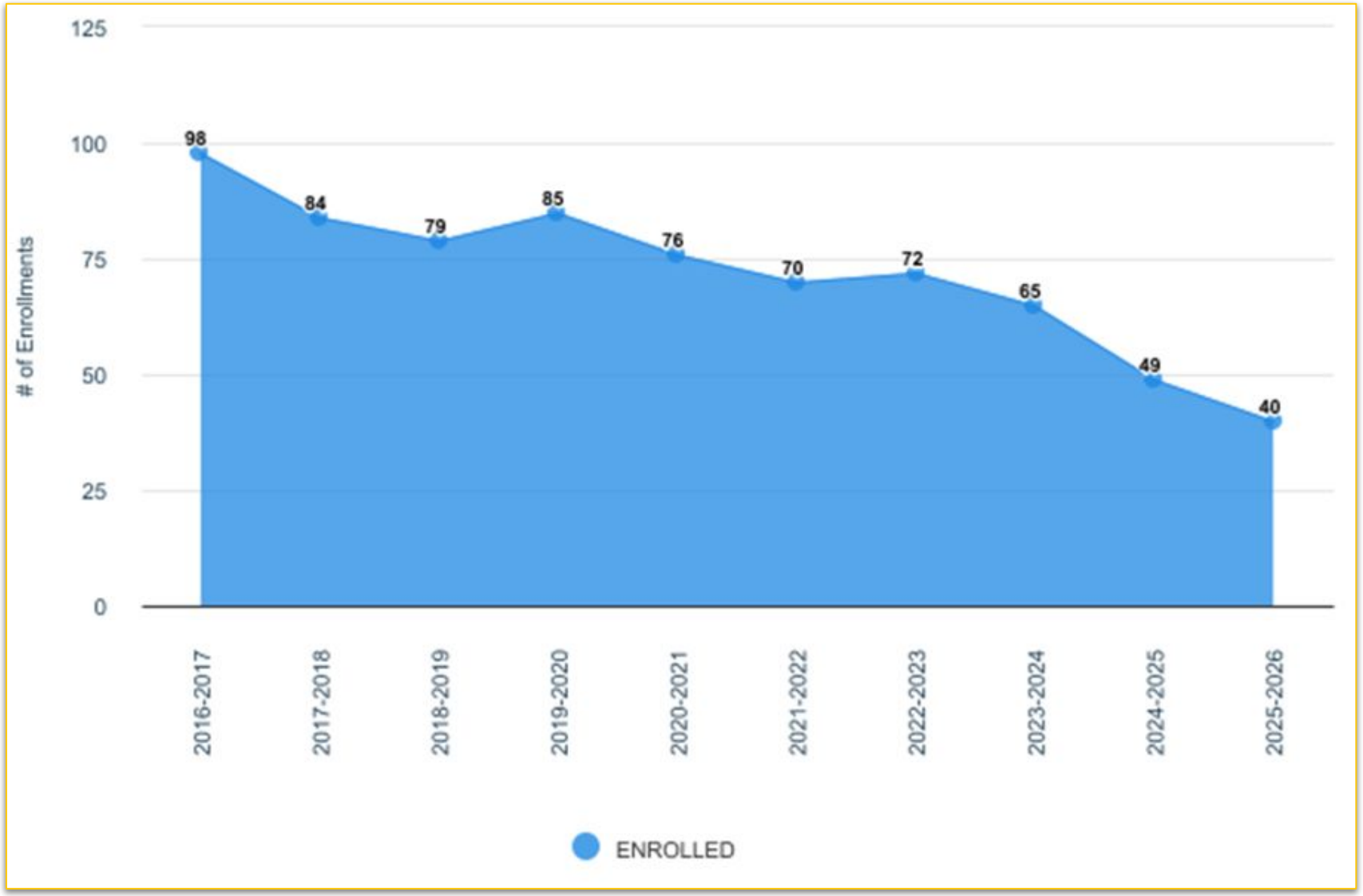
# MLC Enrollment Process

Students enter MLC through two procedures:

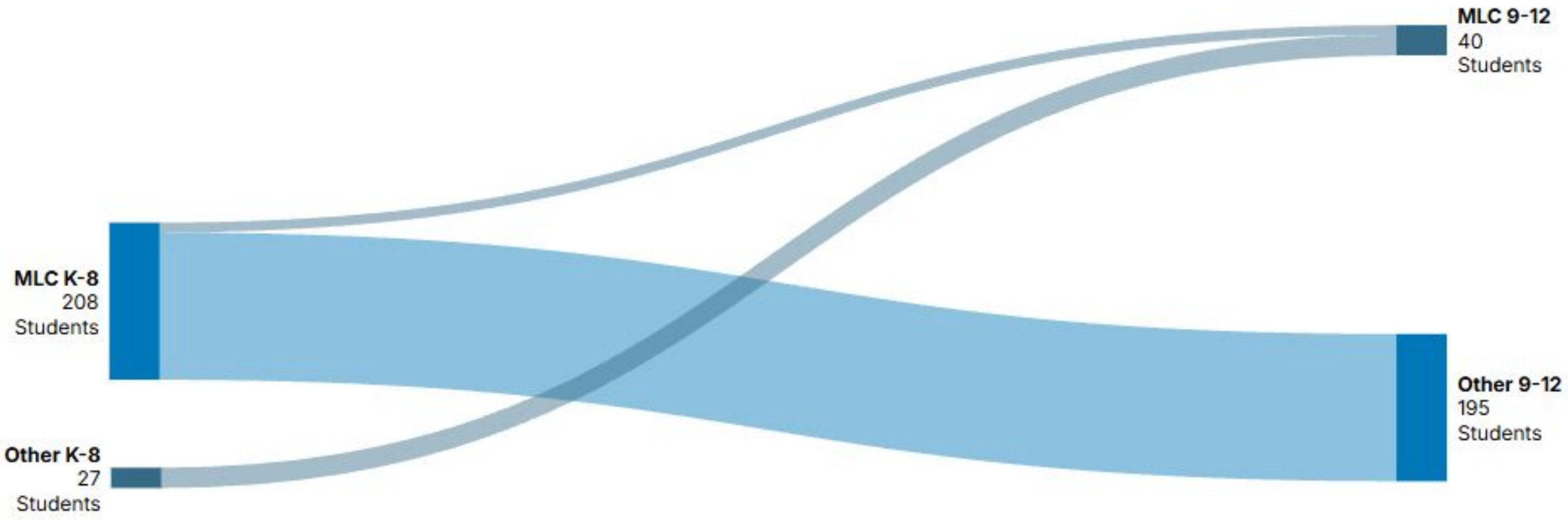
1. **Annual School Choice Lottery**
    i. Online application
    ii. Initial lottery result in January
    iii. Waitlist in place for follow-up offers
    iv. All families encouraged to visit

2. **Reconnection Services Referral**
    i. Students and families discuss goals, interests, and needs with an Outreach Coordinator
    ii. Families meet with school staff before a final decision is made

# MLC HS 10-Year Enrollment Trends



# MLC Student Progression Over the Last Four Years



# Enrollment Demographics

| Student Group | MLC Grades 9-12 | Alliance | All PPS 9-12 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Asian | 0.0% | 0.0% | 5.9% |
| Black | 2.5% | 9.5% | 8.5% |
| Latinx | 7.5% | 19.8% | 17.9% |
| Multi-Racial | 10.0% | 18.6% | 12.0% |
| Native | 0.0% | 0.4% | 0.5% |
| Pacific Islander | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.7% |
| White | 80.0% | 50.2% | 54.4% |

| MLC Grades 9-12 | Students with a Disability | All Students | % Receiving Special Education Services |
|---|---|---|---|
| Totals | 14 | 40 | 35.0% |

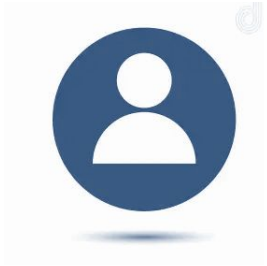
| Descriptor | Number | Percent |
|---|---|---|
| Enrolled in MLC prior to 9th grade | 13 | 32.5% |
| Enrolled in MLC in 9th grade or later | 27 | 67.5% |
| Only High School has been MLC | 33 | 82.5% |
| More than one High School enrollment | 7 | 17.5% |

# Sample MLC Student Profiles



### Brendan

Brendan has had two (2) enrollments. He spent part of grade 9 at Alliance @ Benson HS and the rest of grades 9-11 at MLC.



### Kyle

Kyle has had three (3) enrollments. He split grade 9 among Ida B. Wells, Edwards, and MLC. Since then he has been enrolled in MLC and is in grade 11.



### KC

KC has had four (4) enrollments. They attended Grant, Southern School, Edwards, and MLC for part of grade 9. They are now at MLC and are in grade 11.



### Erin

Currently in grade 12 at MLC, Erin completed grade 9 at Grant and split grades 10 among Online Learning Academy, Mt. Scott Learning Center, and MLC.

# Sample Student Schedules

| Sample 9th Grade Schedule | |
|---|---|
| **Period** | **Course Title** |
| 1 | Spanish 4* |
| 2 | Geometry 2* |
| 3 | Teacher Aide |
| 4 | NGSS Chemistry 2* |
| 5 | Independent Study* |
| 6 | Art 2* |
| 7 | English 2* |
| 8 | Advisory (Wed. Only) |

| Sample 11th Grade Schedule | |
|---|---|
| **Period** | **Course Title** |
| 1 | Health 2* |
| 2 | Geometry 2* |
| 3 | NGSS Biology 2 |
| 4 | English 6* |
| 5 | Virtual Scholars Online Course* |
| 6 | Spanish 2* |
| 7 | Economics* |
| 8 | Advisory (Wed. Only) |

***Note: Denotes courses where more than one course is being taught at the same time or multiple student grade levels are present.**

# MLC and Alliance HS: A Comparison

## MLC

- Grades K-12
- Environmental Education Focus
- Motto “The City is our Campus”
- Programming for cross-age programming
  - MLC Electives Program (adults, middle and high school students can submit a proposal to co-lead an elective with staff for students in grades 1-5 MLC Elective Program
- Student Portfolios, Student led conferences
- Social Emotional Supports for students enrolled
- Advisory model for students in grades 6 -12 (Retro / Metro )
- CTE - Mass Communications,  previously had internships

## Alliance Alternative High School

- Grades 9-12
- Project Based Learning  - Experiential Learning
- School-wide Advisory model
- Programming for integrated content areas to support course completion for students who are course and credit deficient
- Two school models: 5 period block and also a self paced model
- Two school schedules: 5 day and 4 day schedules intended to be flexible schedules to support specific student needs  and remove barriers to continued school enrollment
- Social Emotional Supports for students enrolled
- CTE focus - Natural Resources, Auto, Manufacturing, Digital Media

# Program Staffing Comparisons

## How Many Students Are Needed to Maintain/Sustain Programming?

| 9-12 Comparisons | Teachers Only | Teachers and 1 Social Worker | Teachers, Social Worker, and 1 VP |
|---|---|---|---|
| MLC Projected FTE per Student | 8.3 | 6.8 | 5.8 |
| Alliance 9-12 FTE per student | 16.7 | 15.7 | 14.9 |
| PPS Median High School FTE per student | 21.8 | 21.4 | 20.6 |
| 9-12 MLC Projected Enrollment | 38 | 38 | 38 |
| 9-12 MLC Students Needed To Match Alliance FTE per Student | 77 | 88 | 98 |
| 9-12 MLC Students Needed To Match PPS Median FTE per Student by High School | 100 | 120 | 136 |

# Sustainability of Program

| 25-26 Year | HS Staffing |
|---|---|
| Scheduled Teacher Sections FTE | 4.6 |
| Assistant Principal | 1.0 |
| Social Worker | 1.0 |
| Other | 0.4 |
| Total | 7.0 |

| 25-26 Grades | Student:Staff |
|---|---|
| MLC 9-12 | 5.7 : 1 |
| PPS 9-12 | 17 : 1 |

| MLC at PPS HS Staffing Rates | HS Staffing |
|---|---|
| Teacher FTE | 1.6 |
| Assistant Principal | 1.0 |
| Social Worker | 0 |
| Other | 0 |
| Total | 2.6 |

# Sustainability of Program

## Smaller programs are more costly to operate.

| Student Group | Students | Per Student Costs* |
|---|---|---|
| MLC 9-12 | 40 | $28,120 |
| PPS 9-12 | 13,276 | $8,729 |
| Alliance 9-12 | 275 | $14,221 |

*Note: Per student costs are for the current school year (2025-2026).

Projected savings from discontinuing programming in MLC HS grades is $1.1M.

# High School Alternative and Focus Options

| In-District Alternative Schools |
| --- |
| Alliance High School |

| HS Diploma / Traditional HS Programs |
| --- |
| Mt. Scott Learning Center |
| NAYA Many Nations Academy |
| Rosemary Anderson Prep - Lents |
| Rosemary Anderson Prep - North |
| Helensview |
| Open School |

| Career and College Focused & GED Options |
| --- |
| PCC Yes to College - SE Campus |
| PCC Yes to College - Cascade Campus |
| PCC Yes to College - Sylvania Campus |
| Portland Youth Builders (PYB) |

| Focus Option High Schools |
| --- |
| Jefferson High School |
| Benson High School |

# MLC Student Options Fair

**When:** Tuesday, February 24, from 10:00 am - 11:30 am

**Where:** MLC Auditorium

**When:** Tuesday, February 24, from 4:30 pm - 6:00 pm

**Where:** Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon St.

**The Reconnection Services, Enrollment and Transfer, and representatives from PPS' alternative schools will be available on-site to work individually with students.**

# MLC Student School Tours

**Jefferson High School**

When: Wednesday, February 25, at 2:00 pm

**Benson High School**

When:  Thursday, February 26, at 2:45 pm

**Alliance High School**

When:  Thursday, February 26, at 2:00 pm

**The Reconnection Services Team is ready to support students. Outreach Coordinators will be available to work individually, join the tours, and provide support and information**

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# Q&A